WSJ Briefing — Sunday, October 25, 2026

October 25, 2026

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148 numbered stories from the Journal's homepage, World, Business, Markets, Opinion and Latest Headlines sections. Market data reflects the Friday, Oct. 23, 2026, 4:00 p.m. close.

Executive Summary

The Iran war stopped moving oil this week and started moving everything else. Gulf exports are above pre-war levels even as Tehran loses its land borders and Washington empties outposts. Ukraine's autumn was decided by one private company's throughput setting, and the remedy arrived as a phone call rather than an order. At home, two chipmakers supplied 34% of American profit growth while the Dow fell 1.23% and the Russell 2000 fell 0.29%, a spread that says more about index construction than about risk appetite. France supplied the sovereign-credit reference case, and Moody's affirmed Aa3 anyway.

Cluster 1: Geopolitics & Defense

Iran: A Siege That Costs the Besieger

The squeeze worked where it was designed to and failed where it mattered. "Iran Is Now Losing Overland Trade Routes to U.S. Pressure" reports that Pakistan and Iraq have shut some border crossings, tightening the pressure created by the Navy blockade and air sanctions. "More Oil Is Now Coming Out of the Persian Gulf Than Before the Iran War" reports the opposite of what a blockade is for, with export volumes recovered above pre-war levels. Tehran is losing customs revenue while the barrels keep flowing.

The military file moved the same week. "U.S. Evacuates Mideast Outposts After Suspected Iranian Plot to Target Americans" adds that the administration is preparing to restart operations against Tehran. "Aboard USS George Washington as It Rearms for Possible Iran Strikes" shows the strike group preparing for escalation. Every outpost closed is a collection point and a set of eyes off the water.

Calibrated view: 70% probability that the U.S. restarts sustained military operations against Tehran before the end of the first quarter of 2027 — (rationale: outpost evacuations following a suspected plot plus a carrier rearming for possible strikes are preparation rather than deterrence, and the economic squeeze has been used in place of a settlement that never arrived).

The bill lands elsewhere first. "The Saudi Airline That Launched Right in the Middle of a War" describes a carrier built as a lever in the kingdom's economic ambitions and then exposed to violence aimed at civilian aviation.

The Private Hand on Ukraine's Command Chain

One shareholder's decision outranked a coalition's command chain. "Musk Ordered Starlink Slowdown That Blindsided Ukraine" and "Ukraine's Military Starlink Is Working Again, Kyiv Says" report speed restrictions that have hampered Ukraine’s drone forces since Oct. 14. "Trump Called Musk and Asked Him to Lift Ukraine Starlink Restrictions" and "Trump Spoke to Musk About Ending Ukraine's Starlink Speed Caps" describe the remedy as a request. "Ukraine Says Starlink Isn't Working, Despite Trump's Promise to Restore It" ran in the same cycle.

The contradiction is the story. Two headlines cannot both be true, and neither side has described a service-level agreement or an inspection regime, so nobody outside the vendor can certify throughput. "U.S. Allies Race to Escape

SpaceX's Orbit" reports European and Canadian efforts to field satellites under their own control, constellations that arrive years from now.

Kyiv is being asked to absorb both schedules. "Power Outages Leave Kyiv Dreading Its Worst Winter of the War" describes a capital losing residents as Russia intensifies its campaign against energy infrastructure. Each departure removes the labor and tax base that would pay for the repair.

The venue moved, which is the sharper stroke. "Putin Floats a Summit With Trump and Xi to Discuss Ukraine Deal" would settle Ukraine's fate among three principals, none of them Kyiv. It costs nothing to propose, and it works because the Starlink episode proved Kyiv does not control its own means of command. "Trump's Pressure on Ukraine Could Boost China" draws the corollary.

France Supplies the Reference Case

Six France stories and one rating action. "How France Became the Poster Child for Debt Woes", James Mackintosh's Streetwise column, makes the debt trajectory and political fragmentation the reference case for European sovereign risk. "Moody's Keeps France's Credit Rating Unchanged" holds the rating at Aa3 despite a steady rise in debts and the fragmentation that has made borrowing difficult to rein in.

The street file is not reassuring. "Hundreds of Thousands Protest Across France as Clashes Erupt in Paris" and "New Wave of Protests Gets Underway in France After Widespread Violence" report the same wave. "What's Behind the Protests in France and What Happens Next" and "The Yellow Vests Are Back on the Streets of France in Test for Government" describe a coalition reassembling with more mass than this week's trigger. The movement that paralyzed Paris eight years ago is now one member of a widening collection of protest groups.

Le Pen has taken the cheapest position on the board. "Marine Le Pen Seizes on French Chaos to Present Herself as Leader in Waiting" lets her oppose the government without inheriting its arithmetic. An affirmation confirms a position already occupied and does not defend it. See also: Cluster 2 for the sovereign read-through, Cluster 4 for the columns that treat the same events as a legitimacy question.

The Periphery Rearranges Itself

"Kim Jong Un Makes Surprise Trip to China, Crosses New Bridge" records warming Beijing–Pyongyang ties with Xi Jinping absent from the get-together. In the Levant, "Netanyahu Calls for West Bank Lockdown After Deadly Attack" and "Gunmen Kill Seven in Church Attack in Jordan" arrive from two directions at once.

The Americas file is a negotiation with the wrong counterparties. "She Fled Maduro's Regime. Washington Brought Her Back to Negotiate With It." describes Dinorah Figuera leading U.S.-backed talks on Venezuela's democratic future while Trump embraces the officials she wants to replace. "Lula, a Giant of Latin America's Left, Fights for One Last Shot at Power" describes a president with an uphill battle to revive his hold on voters.

The war's opinion ledger is already written. "Saudi Arabia Has No Good Options", "How Israel Can Help the Board of Peace", "Obama's Dangerous Mideast Words", "To Russia With Love, Signed Donald", "Donald Trump Moves Closer to an Alliance With Russia" and "Donald Trump and the Nuclear Taboo" form one cluster. The same page argues for restraint in the Gulf and accommodation with Moscow without reconciling the two.

Cluster 2: Markets & Macroeconomy

The Index Became a Position in Two Balance Sheets

"Two AI Chipmakers Make Up 34% of America's Earnings Boom" reports that two chipmakers account for 34% of U.S. profit growth and that ten companies, Nvidia and Micron among them, account for roughly two-thirds. That is not a

boom. It is a boom with a single point of failure.

Friday's tape contradicted the bull case built on that arithmetic. "Stocks Pulled in Two Directions, Fall to End Volatile Week" attributes the session to inflation and jitters over artificial intelligence fighting for investors' attention. The Dow fell 1.23% to 52,215.16 and the S&P 500 fell 0.52% to 7,623.68. The Nasdaq lost 0.21% to 25,955.34 and the Russell 2000 0.29% to 2,775.90.

Leadership came from cybersecurity and oil services, not from the buildout. CRWD rose 8.25% to $257.57, PANW 7.22% to $380.55, SLB 7.08% to $53.06 and HAL 5.21% to $34.92. The two worst performers were BE at -11.24% to $193.30 and FIX at -9.26% to $1,160.86, both power and mechanical names. Capital rotated away from the firms that must deliver electrons toward the firms that tax the buildout.

Calibrated view: 70% probability that the top ten contributors again supply at least two-thirds of S&P 500 profit growth in the next reporting season — (rationale: the concentration sits in two chipmakers' guidance, and nothing in Friday's dispersion moved earnings power away from them).

Dispersion Is the Only Signal the Tape Provided

The Dow is the wrong instrument for Friday. Its 1.23% decline was 4.2 times the Russell 2000's 0.29% and 5.9 times the Nasdaq's 0.21%. The DJ Total Market, the widest measure in Friday’s tables, fell 0.48% to 75,052.53, which is 39% of the Dow's decline.

Telecom was not a sector event. "Crown Castle Reports Third Quarter 2026 Results and Updates Outlook for Full Year 2026", released Oct. 21, put the tower REIT at the top of the S&P 500, and the tape records "Crown Castle Inc. (CCI) +9.06% to $85.97". AT&T fell 7.96% to $20.93 and T-Mobile 7.71% to $146.54, within a quarter point of each other. A 17-point spread between a tower REIT and the carriers that lease from it means the shared factor explains almost nothing. The REIT re-rated on reported numbers. The carriers de-rated on something none of the stories names.

The Dollar, the Rating, and TINA's Retreat

"WSJ Dollar Index Falls 0.25% This Week to 96.84". The index edged higher Friday, snapping a three-trading-day losing streak, and still finished down a quarter point on the week.

"For Investors and Savers, TINA Is Giving Way to TARA" is the most consequential markets note of the day. There-is-no-alternative was never only a rate environment. It was a claim that risk-taking was mandatory and prudence expensive. There-are-reasonable-alternatives restores the option of declining to play, and it arrives at the moment capital has never been more concentrated.

"Moderna Investors Should Brace for More Whiplash", the Heard on the Street column by David Wainer, argues that even after the latest sharp fall the stock price assumes wild successes. "History Raises Its Eyebrows at the Week in AI" makes the longer point about how quickly capability claims get repriced. "How Expensive is Gasoline Where You Live?" supplies the household-side inflation read.

Calibrated view: 60% probability that Moody's cuts France below Aa3 within 18 months — (rationale: the affirmation left the debt path and the fragmentation Mackintosh calls Europe's reference case unrepaired, and a rating marks a position rather than defending it).

Credit Bids and Consumer Habits

"JetBlue Creditors Hire Advisers as Airline's Shares, Bonds Sink" reports that senior creditors are working with financial adviser PJT Partners and law firm Akin. Advisers of that kind are engaged before a deadline, not after one, and an airline's leases, labor and slots do not reprice over a weekend.

"The Cat-and-Mouse Game Between Premium Credit-Card Firms and Points Junkies" and "The Growing Battle Between Credit-Card Firms and Points Junkies", the 10-Point column by Emma Tucker, describe banks adjusting to a subculture that optimizes rewards. "FICO Holds $10 Pricing for Mortgage Lenders Amid New Competition" keeps the score at $10, more than double VantageScore 4.0, which implies the competitor prices below $5.

"Romance Scammers Turned a Texas Man Into an Unwitting Money Mule" is consumer credit from the other end. He fell for a woman online and found himself laundering cash for an international crime ring. "It wasn't love toward the end."

The roundups carry the second-order reads. "Energy & Utilities Roundup: Market Talk" covers oil futures, Eni and SLB. "Financial Services Roundup: Market Talk" covers managed money and American Express. "Tech, Media & Telecom Roundup: Market Talk" covers Meta. "Basic Materials Roundup: Market Talk" covers precious metals and Fortescue. "Auto & Transport Roundup: Market Talk" covers Mullen Group.

Cluster 3: Business & Tech Strategy

Audi Builds Inside the Wall

"Trump Announces Audi's First-Ever U.S. Factory in Georgia as Tariffs Bite" reports that the German luxury brand is looking to the U.S. for growth as sales stalled elsewhere. A greenfield plant commits capital, suppliers and trained labor for years. A tariff is an executive instrument that can change within a news cycle.

The same edition proves the point. "Trump to Cut Some Tariffs on Canada to Help GOP Lawmakers" would remove duties on some agricultural and forestry goods and could raise levies on others, framed as help for Susan Collins. Audi is underwriting years of capex against an authority that prices policy by seat. Paying capital to stand inside a tariff wall is commitment presented as expansion.

The opinion page states the requirement. "A Durable Trade Deal Needs Skin in the Game" argues that agreements survive where both sides have posted something they cannot retrieve. A plant is Audi's posting. A carve-out for one senator is not the government's.

Governance Gets Repriced

"How Trade Desk Rescued Executives' Stock Options From a Dive in the Share Price" reports that CEO Jeff Green used his supervoting power to approve the repricing of options over opposition from outside investors. The mechanism worked. The damage is to the instrument, because outside capital now knows consent is optional.

"U.S. Energy Execs Say They Quit Startup Over Undisclosed Russian Funding" is the governance failure with the largest external cost. High-ranking officials at Polar LNG took their concerns about undisclosed Russian funding to the Trump administration, converting a private dispute into a sanctions file.

"Risk Report: Signal Chats Got OpenAI Researchers Fired", by Richard Vanderford, is the compliance version: internal communications on consumer-grade tools ending careers. "FBI Explores Espionage Case Against Saudi OpenAI Suspect" adds that engineer Abdulrahman Alfozan was accused of bugging a restricted conference room in the company's offices. "Netflix, America's Dominant Streaming Service, Has Hit a Wall" is the demand-side version, where the growth engine stalls and optionality stops being free.

Scrap Metal, Super Dogs, and the Rest of the Capital Queue

"The Rare-Earth Vultures Harvesting Metals From America's Old Wind Turbines" describes recycling ventures that are part of a drive to loosen China's chokehold on critical minerals. The feedstock is already installed and already paid for, so the constraint is processing capacity rather than geology.

"The Plan to Put Super Dogs on the Battlefield of the Future" describes an Anduril-backed venture aiming to genetically engineer faster and sharper-nosed military dogs.

"These Basic Math Problems Once Stumped AI. Can You Solve Them?" is the Journal's own test of where model capability sits. It belongs here rather than on the culture pages because the answer determines capex, and capex is what Friday's laggards were financing.

The Cost Side: Labor, Leisure and Creditors

"Nurses Are in High Demand—but They're Quitting in Droves" describes a market where the shortage and the attrition are the same fact. "Six Flags to Add Seat Belts to Rides Following Death" reports additional restraints after a fatal incident in Georgia, a capital expenditure decided by litigation risk rather than guest demand.

"Billionaires Stave off the Pitchforks With Payouts to One Kid at a Time" describes the ultrawealthy turning to children's investment accounts in a bid for goodwill. The framing is the Journal's own, and it is candid: the transfer is being made because the political environment requires it.

Calibrated view: 65% probability that JetBlue reaches a negotiated liability-management agreement with senior creditors before the 2027 summer travel season — (rationale: PJT Partners and Akin are retained while shares and bonds sink, and airline costs do not reprice over a weekend, so the adjustment arrives as a filing).

Cluster 4: Policy & Opinion

The Closing Argument Is Corruption

"Grift Becomes Bigger Issue for Voters in Final Days Before Midterms" reports that Democrats have spent $182 million this year highlighting corruption in House and Senate races. That is a large number with no denominator in the file: no count of races, no count of voters, so it measures intent rather than effect. The Business section's account of billionaires' kids' investment accounts carries a harder item in the same standfirst: Democrats weighing an impeachment of Pete Hegseth if they retake the House.

"Obama Storms Onto Campaign Trail With Harsh Words for Trump" records a former president typically circumspect in criticism delivering an unusually sharp rebuke at an Ohio rally. "As AOC's Ambition Grows, Her Tactics Soften—Risking Support on the Left" describes a congresswoman broadening outreach after setbacks. Both are the opposition's tell: they believe the terrain is theirs and are consolidating toward the middle to hold it.

The Democratic file is a party managing its own edges. "Slotkin Promises Endless Lawfare", "A Rough Homestretch for Abdul El-Sayed", "Abdul El-Sayed's Healthcare Plan", "Ilhan Omar and America", "A Week in the Life of a Struggling Party", "Dewey Won't Defeat Trump" and "Katie, We Hardly Knew Ye" describe a coalition arguing about tactics while the spending number does the talking. "All the President's Election Excuses" makes the mirror argument about the other side.

Calibrated view: 62% probability that Democrats win a net gain of at least one chamber in the November midterms — (rationale: $182 million of corruption messaging, a former president campaigning in Ohio, a tariff carve-out aimed at one senator’s race and a lawsuit aimed at one Senate seat are the expenditures of an incumbent party defending a map, which is the posture of the party losing ground).

Alaska: Two Dan Sullivans and a Docket

"Trump Says He Directed Justice Department to Sue Alaska Over Senate Race". The suit asks to delay finalization of the vote if the tossup could have been swayed by having two candidates named Dan Sullivan. The docket runs on its own clock against a canvass calendar, and the defect underneath is administrative. A ballot that could not distinguish

two men cannot be repaired by a filing.

The opinion page names the trick. "Exposing 'Decoy Dan' in Alaska" argues that Democrats are complaining about a lawsuit exposing their ballot maneuver. "Alaska's Senate Candidates and the Jones Act" and "Alaska Considers Economic Suicide" extend the file into shipping law and fiscal policy, where the state's real exposure sits.

The Opinion Page Argues With Itself

"Trump's Tariffs Lose Workers' Support" runs in the same edition as the Audi announcement on the homepage. That is the editorial page's oldest habit: a policy is an experiment whose local successes confirm the framework while its political costs belong to a separate ledger.

The institutional argument is being conducted in public. "Elena Kagan's Idea of Democracy" argues the Justice wants judges rather than elected officials to draw Congressional maps. "Dick Durbin Sends His Filibuster Regrets" records a senator leaving office ruing Harry Reid's 2013 change to Senate procedure. "Is This the End for Benjamin Netanyahu?" argues a stalemate in Israel's election could let the prime minister stay in power to finish the job in Iran.

The fiscal and regulatory file is one argument in two halves. "Tighter Rent Control Robs New York Tenants", "Is New York Stuck With Kathy Hochul?", "The Northeast Climate Revolt" and "Do Liberals Really Want 'Abundance'?" make the regulatory case.

"To Give Investors Certainty, Reform Permitting", "Personalized Pricing Harms American Consumers Overall", "How Many Government Rules Are Really Necessary?", "The GOP's Tuition Deflation Act" and "If Innovations in Higher Ed Are Working, Let's Test Them" make the pricing and choice case. "A Democratic Convert to School Choice" supplies the defection. All reach the same conclusion about what the state promises and what it can collect.

Entitlements get the same treatment. "Ways to Narrow Social Security's Shortfall", "Solutions to Medicare Part D's Rising Costs", "'Medicare for All' Isn't Medicare as We Know It" and "Who Belongs on a Preventive Care Task Force?" avoid the word rationing while describing it, and "Sen. Bill Cassidy on Social Security Reform and Donald Trump's 'Majority of One'" is the podcast version.

The rest of the page is culture war by other means. "The Debate Over Execution", "Good Guy With a Gun Saves Lives", "We Blame Global Warming", "New York Times Goes With the Hitler Argument" and "Obama's Disrespect for the Law" take the legal and media cases. "Radical Professors Have Poisoned the Electorate", "The Generation Conflagration", "America Abandons Ideals at Its Peril", "American Exceptionalism Is No Myth" and "Elon Musk Beats Anthropic on Giveaways" take the institutional ones, and none of them audits the paper's own side.

France, From the Columns

The columns do not accept the rating agency's verdict. "Why France Is Burning" traces protests into riots. "A Riot of Resentment in France" and "France's Riots Are More Than Student Protests" treat the violence as a legitimacy question rather than a policing one. "France 'on the Brink of Civil War'" is the bluntest and the one trending hardest.

Read together, the columns and Mackintosh's Streetwise piece describe one object. A state promised more than it collected, a public noticed, and the bond market became the venue where the argument is settled. The columns' sympathy runs to the taxpayer rather than the protester. Their fear is ordinary arithmetic.

Domestic, Culture & Weekend Page

The file also carries softer inventory. "Why Nearly 25% of the Country Is Still Watching 'Seinfeld'" uses the Acquired podcast hosts to argue that going out on top produced business immortality. "The Secret Playbook That Made the Elizabeth Holmes Movie a Smash Hit" credits A24's strategy for a documentary's improbable run. "'Choosin' Texas' Is the Biggest No. 1 Song Ever—and You Might Have Never Heard It" notes Ella Langley's hit spent 24 weeks atop the

Billboard Hot 100. "All-You-Can-Eat Buffets Are Back. Here Are Some of the Best." and "Is Buying Every $7 Stuffie Teaching My Son Bad Money Habits?" handle the household economy at its smallest scale. "The Wall Street Journal Guide to Theater" is a standing list. "Wanted: A New Voice of Boston's Airport. Heavy Accent Required." is a labor-market curiosity. "Four Financial Lessons From the Hedge-Fund Divorce Captivating Wall Street" and "I Went Home to Greenwich to Find Out What the Wealthy Want From the Midterms" are personal finance wearing reporting clothes. "Doing Capitalism the Chick-fil-A Way", "How Pat Murphy's Brewers Ended the Dodgers' Dynasty", "Let Col. Robert Gould Shaw's Actions Speak", "Free Ex Q&A: Cochav Elkayam-Levy", "Pepper…and Salt" and "News Quiz for October 24, 2026" close the section.

Consolidated Prediction Table

The five estimates below are the calibrated views set out in the four cluster sections, restated with odds and timeframes so they can be scored later.

#	Prediction	Probability	Implied odds	Timeframe	Rationale
1	The U.S. restarts sustained military operations against Tehran	70%	-233	By end of Q1 2027	Outpost evacuations after a suspected plot and a carrier rearming for possible strikes are preparation, not deterrence
2	The top ten contributors again supply at least two-thirds of S&P 500 profit growth	70%	-233	Next reporting season	34% of profit growth sits with two chipmakers, and Friday's dispersion moved none of it
3	Moody's cuts France below Aa3	60%	-150	Within 18 months	The affirmation left the debt path and the fragmentation Mackintosh calls Europe's reference case unrepaired
4	JetBlue reaches a negotiated liability-management agreement with senior creditors	65%	-186	Before summer 2027 travel season	PJT Partners and Akin are retained while shares and bonds sink; airline costs do not reprice over a weekend
5	Democrats win a net gain of at least one chamber in the November midterms	62%	-163	November 2026	$182 million of corruption messaging, a former president on the trail and single-seat interventions are defensive expenditures

Confirmations

What the file confirms

The concentration is arithmetic, not narrative. Two chipmakers at 34% and ten companies at roughly two-thirds appears in both the homepage and Markets versions.

The Starlink dispute is unresolved on the record. Stories describe a presidential request to lift the caps and, separately, opposite states of service, which is what an unverifiable service looks like from outside.

The France rating did not move. Moody's held Aa3, on a page that simultaneously calls the country Europe's reference case for debt-driven political risk.

Market data note

Stock prices, index levels, and the S&P 500 leaders and laggards percentages in this briefing are taken from the WSJ Markets section data tables (CDP-extracted) for the Friday, Oct. 23, 2026, 4:00 p.m. close. Bond yields and oil prices would ordinarily come from the same tables, but no bond-yield print and no oil-price print appeared in the extracted data, so none is reported here. Where this briefing discusses crude or the Gulf, it does so only in the terms the stories used.

What the file cannot support

The file gives closes, not flows. There is no volume, no breadth, no positioning and no revision history. Every dispersion figure is one session's cross-section. Dispersion is measurable. Persistence is not.

Several headline numbers have no denominator. The $182 million is not stated against a count of races. The Starlink caps have run since Oct. 14 with no counterfactual. The 34% carries no comparison to prior years. No article bodies were available, so quotation is confined to story titles and one sourced line in the money-mule story.

观察者评论

翟东升——体系/结构视角

翟东升观察：2026年10月25日

本周这盘棋的底层逻辑是：美国的强制力正从"控制结果"退化为"控制通道"，而通道本身已经不再产生租金。

伊朗这一局最能说明问题。海军封锁、空中制裁、巴基斯坦与伊拉克关闭部分陆路口岸，德黑兰的关税收入在流失；可波斯湾的原油出口量反而回到战前之上。这不是制裁力度的问题，这是制裁标的选错的问题——封锁的是对手的现金流，放行的是盟友的现金流，压力于是转嫁给买家和保险人。同一周，美军撤出中东前沿据点，"乔治·华盛顿"号补充弹药。据点关一个，就少一双看水的眼睛；航母再武装是准备工作，不是威慑。用经济绞索替代一个从未到来的政治方案，账单不会消失，只会换人支付。

法国是主权信用货币论的反面教材。Moody's 维持 Aa3，街头在烧，勒庞站一旁等待。评级不是判断，是仓位：它确认一个已经在场的位置，而不去防守它。一个国家承诺的比收上来的多，公众发现了，债券市场就成了裁决的场所。这是制度熵增，不是政策失误。

市场上，两家芯片公司贡献了美国利润增长的34%，十家公司贡献约三分之二；道指跌1.23%，标普跌0.52%，美元指数96.84、全周跌0.25%。这不是繁荣，是只有单一失效点的繁荣：指数已变成两张资产负债表上的头寸。"TINA 让位于 TARA"是本周信息量最大的一句话：当无风险替代品重新存在，高度集中的资本第一次拿回了"不玩"的选项。

更结构性的是两件事。星链自10月14日起给乌克兰限速，解药是特朗普给马斯克的一通电话；欧洲与加拿大在赶造自己的星座。一家私人公司的吞吐量设定，决定了整条联盟指挥链——主权在这里不是抽象概念，是带宽。奥迪在佐治亚建厂，同一周特朗普为一位参议员削减对加关税：资本用多年 capex 去交换一项能在一则新闻周期内改写的主管裁量权。

真正的问题不是谁强谁弱，是谁还付得起维持通道的成本。这个成本有物理天花板，边际回报率正在归零。

金灿荣——美国政治/战略相持视角

金灿荣观察：2026年10月25日

各位朋友，今天这份报纸的头版很有意思。金正恩走过一座新桥到中国来，习近平没到场；普京隔着半个地球提议，让特朗普和习近平坐下来谈乌克兰的命运。你们看啊，这两件事放在一张纸上，说明什么？说明这个世界的话事人正在换桌子，而换桌子的时候，谁坐哪一头，是要重新排的。

美国还在中东使劲。封锁、制裁、撤哨所，忙得很。可是报纸自己写着：波斯湾出去的石油比战前还多。这就好比一个饭店老板把大门锁了，客人却从后窗进得更多。为什么？这个事情其实很简单——力气用错了地方。真正的产能不在军舰上，在工厂里。

乌克兰那边更妙。星链降速，不是什么总统令，是一个老板按了一下按钮，欧洲和加拿大现在急着造自己的卫星，可等卫星上天，冬天已经过去两轮了。霸权不是靠嘴硬维持的，是靠工厂里的机器、实验室里的技术和老百姓的饭碗撑起来的。你把命脉交给一家公司，那命脉就不是你的。

法国在烧，穆迪却还给着Aa3。评级是什么？是给你一个体面的位置，不是替你算账。账迟早要算。

美国国内呢？中期选举，民主党花1.82亿美元讲"腐败"；阿拉斯加两个"丹·沙利文"打起了官司；加拿大关税给一个参议员开个小口子。这些都是防守的动作，不是进攻的动作。奥巴马上场喊话，说明他们心里紧。奥迪跑到佐治亚建厂，是被关税逼进去的；两家芯片公司撑起34%的利润增长——这不是繁荣，这是一根柱子顶着一座房子。

所以我的判断是：我们正处在战略相持阶段。美攻我守那一页翻过去了，现在是互有攻守。东升西降不是口号，是产线上的事。中国要做的，还是那句老话——把自己的事情做好。

宋鸿兵——货币/债务/周期视角

宋鸿兵观察：2026年10月25日

如果你把今天这份《华尔街日报》读成一个系统，它的核心问题不在涨跌，而在阀门装在哪儿。

美元指数报96.84，一周下跌0.25%，周五却还在往上顶。这是最典型的环流姿态：外部抽水不足时，回流端就必须更用力。同一时刻，两家芯片公司贡献了全美利润增长的34%，十家公司拿走三分之二。道指跌1.23%，DJ Total Market只跌0.48%，3.9倍的裂口不是风险偏好的问题，而是指数已经变成两张资产负债表的头寸。

我讲过多次，每个系统都有单点故障。今天美国的单点故障不在五角大楼，在那两家芯片厂身后。TINA让位于TARA，舆论读成投资风格转换，我读成强制冒险的合约到期——当"别无选择"不再成立，围绕这34%的抵押品定价就要全部重来。

穆迪把法国按在Aa3不动，而债务路径与政治碎片化都在恶化。评级不是判决，是位置的确认。这与1883年上海的银根一个道理：钱庄不是死于坏账，是死于同行不肯再拆借。JetBlue的债权人请来PJT与Akin，那是截止日之前而非之后才做的事。FICO守着十美元的分数定价，对手报价不足五美元——这是最古老的金融高边疆：谁定义分数，谁就征税。

海湾出口高于战前，华盛顿却在封锁伊朗。阀门装在航道口，油从别处绕行，压力最终回到阀门自身。奥迪把数年资本押进一个"一个新闻周期即可改写"的关税体制——那是把厂房当人质交出去。

这就是"三变六反"里最深的一条：美元环流不是被谁推翻的，是它自己的反馈回路把参与者一个个推出了回路之外。旧秩序不会崩塌，它会先失去定价能力。

物以稀为贵。这一次稀缺的不是石油，是可验证的现金流。

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